

SEUNGJI LEE

HUMANITARIAN PROFESSIONAL & RESEARCHER

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ABOUT ME

Dedicated humanitarian professional and emerging researcher with extensive field experience in managing projects, fostering partnerships, and delivering results in complex refugee settings. Currently pursuing a Master's degree in Political Science while conducting research on refugee livelihoods and women's economic empowerment. Seeking to bridge humanitarian practice and academic research to contribute evidence-based solutions for conflict-affected communities worldwide.

EDUCATION

MASTER'S CANDIDATE IN POLITICAL SCIENCE

Kangwon National University, Chuncheon, ROK | Mar 2025 - Present

- Research focus: Refugee livelihoods, Refugee women's economic empowerment, and forced migration

BACHELOR OF ARTS (ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE), B.A IN INTERNATIONAL COMMERCE

Ajou University, Gyeonggi-do, ROK | 2017

WORK EXPERIENCE

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Kangwon Institute for Unification Studies, Kangwon National University | Mar 2025 - Present

Description of Duties:

- Lead field research on refugee education, livelihoods, and sustainable self-reliance in Bangladesh and Thailand.
- Conduct research projects on forced displacement, refugee women's economic empowerment, and self-reliance.

Summary of Achievements:

- Conducted field research on refugee education and teacher status in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh, funded by KAIDEC-KOICA Field Research Incubating Program.
- Completed field assessment on sustainable self-reliance of refugees and organizations in Mae Sot, Thailand, funded by a private foundation.

FIELD PROJECT MANAGER

Asian Dignity Initiative (ADI), Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh | Jan 2022 - Feb 2025

Description of Duties:

- Collaborated closely with Rohingya women-led local NGOs in the Cox's Bazar refugee camp to enhance projects and strategies through stakeholder analysis.
- Provided technical assistance and support to local NGOs by facilitating workshops on gender, coordination, and project management.
- Developed and executed a multi-year Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) plan, delivering comprehensive annual evaluation reports.
- Coordinated with local governments and humanitarian actors in Bangladesh.
- Managed donor relationships, securing critical funding opportunities.

Summary of Achievements:

- Secured multi-year project funding (2022-2024) by engaging five donors, including KOICA.
- Achieved perfect scores on donor accounting audits since 2021.
- Enabled 81% of women to generate income through a community business program.
- Expanded women's center reach to 13,991 users with 3,332 registered women.
- Achieved KOICA External Evaluation score of 19.5/20, rated Grade A ("Highly Successful") for the 2021–2024 Psychosocial Support Project.

M&E OFFICER

Asian Dignity Initiative (ADI), Seoul, ROK | Jan 2021 - Dec 2021

- Contributed to developing an annual M&E plan and delivering evaluation reports.
- Facilitated workshops on gender, coordination, and project management.

- Led a needs assessment involving 90 participants for future projects.

PART-TIMER

Plan International Korea, Gyeonggi, ROK | Jul 2020 - Jan 2021

- Facilitated translation of project details and beneficiary information.
- Communicated with overseas offices to address information-related issues.

ASSISTANT OFFICER

Medical Aid for Children, Seoul, ROK | Nov 2017 - Dec 2019

- Researched healthcare impact on North Korean human rights for donor and stakeholder sharing.
- Implemented five projects under sanctions, securing funding from six donors.
- Attained UN sanctions humanitarian exemptions for North Korea.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Skills: Research and Analysis (STATA, R), Project Management (PCM), Computer Specialist in Spreadsheet and Database, Stakeholder Management, Interpersonal Skills (Team Building)

Languages: Korean (Native), English (Fluent), Bengali (Basic)

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Kong, Seonju, Seungji Lee, Young Hoon Song, and Sanghoon Park. 2025. "Motivations for Humanitarian Assistance Activists' Participation in Public Education in South Korea." *Korean Journal of International Migration* 12(2): 147–174. Published in Korean.

Books

- Lee, Seungji, Seonju Kong, Solbi Jeon, Minkyung Oro, and Yukyung Lee. 2024. *We Want to Dance But Our Houses Are Too Small: The Story of Shanti-Khana, A Women's Community Space in a Rohingya Refugee Camp*. Fascicles.

Reports

- Asian Dignity Initiative. 2024. "Psychosocial Support Project for Rohingya and Host Community Women; Resilience Building, Phase 5 (2022–2024) – Baseline Assessment Report, Project Evaluation Report." ReliefWeb. Contributing author.
- Asian Dignity Initiative. 2024. "Operations Manual of Multipurpose Women's Healing Center (MWHC) in Rohingya Refugee Camps." ReliefWeb. Contributing author.
- Asian Dignity Initiative. 2021. "Stories from Shanti Khana." ReliefWeb. Contributing author.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Lee, Seungji, Sanghoon Park, Yoojin Lim, and Young Hoon Song. 2025. "Thriving in Confinement: What Enables Rohingya Refugee Women's Economic Empowerment in Cox's Bazar." Under review.

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

- Essentials of Humanitarian Negotiations (EHN) Workshop - UNHCR (Apr 2024)
- Advanced Training in Performance Management for Humanitarian Aid Workers - KCOC (Mar 2022)
- Sphere in Practice - Sphere (Nov 2021)
- Gender and Development (GAD) Advanced Academy - Korea Women's Association United (Jun 2021)
- Project Cycle Management Training - IOM (Jun 2018)

PERSONAL DETAILS

Date of Birth: 20 Feb 1995 | **Nationality:** Republic of Korea